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BATTERY CELL AND MANUFACTURING METHOD THEREOF

Abstract

The present disclosure relates to a battery cell including a case including an opening formed in one surface and an opposing surface facing the opening, and accommodating an electrode assembly through the opening, a cap plate coupled to the case to close the opening, and a vent portion having a shape of a groove on the opposing surface, wherein a ten-point average roughness of a surface of the vent portion is greater than a ten-point average roughness of an area adjacent to the vent portion.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED PATENT APPLICATION

[0001] The present application claims priorities under 35 U.S.C. § 119(a) to Korean patent application number 10-2024-0030270 filed on Feb. 29, 2024, and Korean patent application number 10-2024-0119341 filed on Sep. 3, 2024 in the Korean Intellectual Property Office, the entire disclosures of which are incorporated by reference herein.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

1. Field

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a secondary battery, and more specifically, to a battery cell and a method of manufacturing the battery cell.

2. Description of the Related Art

[0003] Secondary batteries convert electrical energy into chemical energy and store the chemical energy so that the secondary batteries can be reused multiple times through charging and discharging. Secondary batteries are widely used throughout the industry due to their economical and eco-friendly characteristics. In particular, lithium secondary batteries are widely used in the entire industry, including portable devices which require high-density energy.

[0004] The operating principle of lithium secondary batteries is the electrochemical oxidation-reduction reaction. In other words, electricity is generated by the movement of lithium ions and is charged in the opposite process. In the case of a lithium secondary battery, a phenomenon in which lithium ions from an anode escape and move to a cathode through an electrolyte and a separator is called discharge. In addition, the opposite process of the phenomenon is called charge.

[0005] As the processes of charging and discharging the secondary battery are repeated, a swelling phenomenon may occur in which internal pressure increases and a large amount of heat is generated. Since this swelling phenomenon may lead to explosions or fires, methods of controlling the internal pressure of the secondary batteries are required.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

[0006] An object of the present disclosure is to provide a battery cell with improved stability by controlling internal pressure.

[0007] Another object of the present disclosure is to provide a battery cell in which internal pressure is controlled by changing the shape of a vent portion.

[0008] Another object of the present disclosure is to provide a battery cell in which a vent portion has a ring shape to surround an electrode terminal.

[0009] The present disclosure can be widely applied in the fields of electric vehicles, battery charging stations, and other green technologies such as photovoltaics and wind power using batteries. In addition, the present disclosure may be used in eco-friendly mobility, including electric vehicles and hybrid vehicles, to prevent climate change by suppressing air pollution and greenhouse fluid emissions.

[0010] A battery cell according to embodiments of the present disclosure may include a case including an opening formed in one surface and an opposing surface facing the opening, and accommodating an electrode assembly through the opening, a cap plate coupled to the case to close the opening, and a vent portion having a shape of a groove on the opposing surface, wherein a ten-point average roughness of a surface of the vent portion is greater than a ten-point average roughness of an area adjacent to the vent portion.

[0011] The vent portion may include a ring shape on a side toward an outside of the case among both sides of the opposing surface.

[0012] The battery cell may further include a first current collector plate disposed between the opposing surface and the electrode assembly in the case and electrically connected to the electrode

assembly.

[0013] The battery cell may further include an electrode terminal electrically connected to the first current collector plate and exposed to the outside through the opposing surface.

[0014] The vent portion may be changed in shape based on internal pressure of the case.

[0015] At least a portion of the vent portion may be opened when the internal pressure of the case increases.

[0016] The groove may include a thickness less than or equal to one-sixth of a thickness of the opposing surface.

[0017] The area adjacent to the vent portion may include a structure in a form of a plurality of grains, and a structure of the area adjacent to the vent portion includes an equiaxed microstructure, or the plurality of grains are isotropic.

[0018] One of the plurality of grains may be at least partially cut.

[0019] The vent portion may include a re-solidification layer formed by heating and solidifying a portion by using a laser.

[0020] The ten-point average roughness of the surface of the vent portion may exceed 20.

[0021] A battery cell according to embodiments of the present disclosure may include an electrode assembly including a first electrode (an anode), a separator, and a second electrode (a cathode), a case including an opening formed in one surface and an opposing surface facing the opening, and accommodating an electrode assembly through the opening to be electrically connected to the second electrode, a cap plate coupled to the case to close the opening, and a vent portion having a shape of a groove in the opposing surface.

[0022] The battery cell may further include an electrode terminal electrically connected to the first electrode and exposed to an outside through the opposing surface.

[0023] The vent portion may include a ring shape surrounding the electrode terminal on a side facing the outside of the case among both sides of the opposing surface.

[0024] The battery cell may further include a first current collector plate electrically connected to the first electrode between the opposing surface and the first electrode in the case, and a second current collector plate electrically connected to the second electrode between the cap plate and the second electrode in the case.

[0025] A method of manufacturing a battery cell accommodating an electrode assembly including a first electrode, a separator, and a second electrode in a case including an opening formed in one surface of the battery cell and an opposing surface facing the opening according to embodiments of the present disclosure may include forming a vent portion by processing the opposing surface.

[0026] The forming the vent portion may include forming a start groove of the vent portion by a laser, and etching the opposing surface through the laser so that the vent portion forms a ring shape in the start groove.

[0027] The method may further include, after the forming of the vent portion: coupling a first current collector plate with the first electrode and a second current collector plate to the second electrode, and inserting the electrode assembly into the case through the opening so that the first current collector plate faces the opposing surface.

[0028] The method may further include coupling a cap plate to the case to close the opening after the inserting of the electrode assembly into the case.

[0029] A battery cell according to embodiments of the present disclosure may include a case including an opening formed in one surface and an opposing surface facing the opening, and accommodating the electrode assembly through the opening, a cap plate coupled to the case to close the opening, and a vent portion having a shape of a groove on the opposing surface, wherein a surface of the vent portion is rougher than a surface of an area adjacent to the vent portion.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0030] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating a battery cell according to an embodiment.

[0031] FIG. 2 is an exploded view of a battery cell according to an embodiment.

[0032] FIG. 3 is a diagram for explaining an electrode assembly according to an embodiment.

[0033] FIG. 4 is a diagram of an electrode assembly in a wound state according to an embodiment.

[0034] FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view of a battery cell according to an embodiment.

[0035] FIG. 6 is a diagram for explaining an opposing surface of a battery cell according to an embodiment.

[0036] FIG. 7 is a view for explaining a cross section of a vent portion according to an embodiment.

[0037] FIG. 8 is a diagram illustrating a method of manufacturing a battery cell according to an embodiment.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0038] Hereinafter, the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the accompanying drawings. This is, however, illustrative only and is not intended to limit the disclosure to the specific embodiments illustratively described.

[0039] FIG. 1 is a diagram illustrating a battery cell **100** according to an embodiment.

[0040] Referring to FIG. 1, the battery cell **100** according to an embodiment may include a case **110**, a cap plate **120**, and a vent portion **190**.

[0041] The battery cell **100** may be a secondary battery which can be charged and discharged multiple times.

[0042] For example, the secondary battery may be one of, but not limited to, a lithium cobalt battery, a lithium high nickel battery, a lithium iron phosphate battery, a lithium ion battery, a lithium polymer battery, a lithium sulfur battery, a nickel hydrogen battery, a nickel cadmium battery, a sodium battery, and an all-solid-state battery, and may also include other various types of secondary batteries.

[0043] The case **110** may include an opening **114** formed on one surface and an opposing surface **111** facing the opening **114**. The case **110** may receive the electrode assembly **160** therein through the opening **114**. The case **110** may accommodate a current collector plate **140** electrically connected to the electrode assembly **160** therein.

[0044] The opposing surface **111** is opened similarly to the opening **114**, so that the case **110** may have a cylindrical shape with both sides opened. Alternatively, the opposing surface **111** may be closed differently from the opening **114**, so that the case **110** may have a 'U' shape in which only one surface having the opening **114** is open.

[0045] For example, the case **110** may have the shape of a container which is partially open.

[0046] In an embodiment, the case **110** may include a material such as various metals such as iron and aluminum, alloys thereof, plastic, ceramic, or carbon.

[0047] In an embodiment, the case **110** may include the opposing surface **111** and a side surface portion **113**.

[0048] The opposing surface **111** may extend from an upper end or a lower end of the side surface portion **113**. The upper end and the lower end may be one of ends in a height direction (e.g., a Z-axis direction). For example, the opposing surface **111** may extend from the top of the side surface portion **113**. In the embodiment, it is assumed that the opposing surface **111** is disposed at the top of the case **110**, and the opening **114** is disposed at the bottom thereof.

[0049] At least a part of the opposing surface **111** may be formed as a flat surface with no changes in height in a horizontal direction (e.g., an X-axis direction or a Y-axis direction). The area excluding the vent portion **190** from the opposing surface **111** may be formed as a flat surface.

[0050] The opposing surface **111** may have a circular shape with respect to an XY plane. However, the present disclosure is not limited thereto, and the shape of the opposing surface **111** may be

changed into an ellipse, a triangle, a rectangle, a polygon, or the like. The side surface portion **113** may extend in the height direction (e.g., the Z-axis direction) from the edge of the opposing surface **111**. In an embodiment, the opposing surface **111** and the side surface portion **113** may be formed integrally with or separately from each other.

[0051] In an embodiment, a beading portion **115** may be formed on the side surface portion **113**. The beading portion **115** may be a portion of the side surface portion **113** which is bent toward the inside surrounded by the side surface portion **113**. In an embodiment, the opening **114** with one end opened may have the case **110**.

[0052] The opening **114** may be formed on the opposite side of the opposing surface **111** in the height direction (e.g., the Z-axis direction).

[0053] For example, when the opposing surface **111** is formed at the top of the side surface portion **113**, the opening **114** may be formed at the bottom of the side surface portion **113**. The electrode assembly **160** and the current collector plate **140** may be inserted into the case **110** through the opening **114**. Subsequently, the beading portion **115** may have one region of the side surface portion **113** adjacent to the opening **114**.

[0054] The cap plate **120** may seal the case **110**. The cap plate **120** may be coupled to the case **110** to close the opening **114**.

[0055] In an embodiment, after the electrode assembly **160** and the current collector plate **140** are accommodated in the case **110**, the cap plate **120** may be coupled to the case **110**.

[0056] That is, the case **110** and the cap plate **120** may surround the outside of the electrode assembly **160** and the current collector plate **140**. In an embodiment, the cap plate **120** and the case **110** coupled to each other may have a cylindrical shape. However, this is only one embodiment, and the shapes of the cap plate **120** and the case **110** coupled to each other may be changed into various shapes such as a square or a hexahedron.

[0057] In an embodiment, the cap plate **120** may be located on the opposite side of the opposing surface **111**. For example, when the opposing surface **111** is formed at the top of the side surface portion **113**, the cap plate **120** may be coupled to the bottom of the side surface portion **113**.

[0058] In an embodiment, the opposing surface **111** may include the vent portion **190** having a shape of a groove.

[0059] The vent portion **190** may be formed on a side facing the outside of the case **110** among both sides of the opposing surface **111**. The vent portion **190** may be recessed inwards from the opposing surface **111**. The vent portion **190** may have a smaller thickness or a less height than an adjacent region.

[0060] In an embodiment, the vent portion **190** may have a ring or donut shape on the opposing surface **111**. The vent portion **190** may be connected along the circumference of the opposing surface **111** and have a continuous shape.

[0061] The vent portion **190** having a relatively small thickness or a relatively low height may be formed on the opposing surface **111**. When the internal pressure of the case **110** increases, the shape of the vent portion **190** may be changed before the area adjacent to the vent portion **190**.

[0062] In an embodiment, the vent portion **190** may be spaced apart from an electrode terminal **130** exposed to the outside on the opposing surface **111**. The vent portion **190** has a circumference longer than the circumference of the electrode terminal **130**, and may surround the electrode terminal **130**.

[0063] FIG. 2 is an exploded view of the battery cell **100** according to an embodiment.

[0064] Referring to FIG. 2, the battery cell **100** according to an embodiment may include the case **110**, the cap plate **120**, an electrode assembly **160**, the current collector plate **140**, the electrode terminal **130**, and an insulating gasket **135**.

[0065] FIG. 2 shows the battery cell **100** as viewed from the bottom, and the opposing surface **111** formed at the top of the battery cell **100** and including the vent portion **190** is not shown in FIG. 2. The opening **114** formed at the bottom of the battery cell **100** is shown.

[0066] In an embodiment, the electrode assembly **160** may include a first electrode **171**, a second electrode **175**, and a separator **180**, which will be described below in detail with reference to FIGS. **3** and **4**.

[0067] In an embodiment, the current collector plate **140** may include at least one of a first current collector plate **141** and a second current collector plate **142**. The first current collector plate **141** may be disposed between the opposing surface **111** of the case **110** and the electrode assembly **160**. The second current collector plate **142** may be disposed between the cap plate **120** and the electrode assembly **160**.

[0068] The current collector plate **140** may be electrically connected to the electrode of the electrode assembly **160**. To this end, the current collector plate **140** may include a conductive material such as copper, gold, silver, or aluminum. The electrode may include the first electrode **171** and the second electrode **175**.

[0069] In an embodiment, the first current collector plate **141** and the second current collector plate **142** may be electrically connected to different electrodes of the electrode assembly **160**. For example, the first current collector plate **141** may be connected to the first electrode **171**, and the second current collector plate **142** may be connected to the second electrode **175**. In an embodiment, the first current collector plate **141** may be electrically connected to the electrode terminal **130**. The second current collector plate **142** may be electrically connected to the case **110** and/or the cap plate **120**.

[0070] The first current collector plate **141** may be disposed between the opposing surface **111** and the electrode assembly **160** in the case **110**. The first current collector plate **141** may be electrically connected to the first electrode **171** of the electrode assembly **160**.

[0071] The second current collector plate **142** may be disposed between the cap plate **120** and the electrode assembly **160** in the case **110**. The second current collector plate **142** may be electrically connected to the second electrode **175** of the electrode assembly **160**.

[0072] In an embodiment, the electrode terminal **130** may be located on the opposite side of the cap plate **120** in the height direction (e.g., the Z-axis direction). The electrode terminal **130** is electrically connected to the current collector plate **140** and may be exposed to the outside through the opposing surface **111**. The electrode terminal **130** may be electrically connected to an external device. That is, current may flow to the external device through the electrode terminal **130**.

[0073] In an embodiment, the electrode terminal **130** may be inserted into a through hole of the case **110**.

[0074] In an embodiment, the electrode terminal **130** may be a rivet. In an embodiment, the through hole may have the opposing surface **111** of the case **110**. For example, the through hole may be formed by penetrating the center of the opposing surface **111**. The electrode terminal **130** may pass through the center of the opposing surface **111** and be exposed to the outside.

[0075] In an embodiment, the insulating gasket **135** may be disposed between the case **110** and the electrode terminal **130**. For example, the insulating gasket **135** may be disposed between the opposing surface **111** of the case **110** and the electrode terminal **130**. The insulating gasket **135** may include an insulating material. The insulating material may include materials with low electrical conductivity, such as polymers and ceramics.

[0076] FIG. **3** is a diagram illustrating the electrode assembly **160** according to an embodiment. FIG. **4** is a diagram of the electrode assembly **160** in a wound state according to an embodiment.

[0077] FIG. **3** is a partial exploded view of the wound electrode assembly **160**, and FIG. **4** shows the electrode assembly **160** with a flag. Referring to FIGS. **3** and **4**, the electrode assembly **160** according to an embodiment may include an electrode **170** and the separator **180**.

[0078] The electrode **170** may include the first electrode **171** and the second electrode **175**. The first electrode **171** and the second electrode **175** may have different polarities. For example, the first electrode **171** may be an anode and the second electrode **175** may be a cathode. For another example, the first electrode **171** may be a cathode and the second electrode **175** may be an anode.

[0079] The electrode **170** may be an electrode plate on which an active material is applied in one region. In an embodiment, the first electrode **171** may include a first non-coated portion **171a** to which a first active material is not applied, and a first coated portion **171b** to which the first active material is applied. The second electrode **175** may include a second non-coated portion **175a** to which a second active material is not applied and a second coated portion **175b** to which the second active material is applied.

[0080] In an embodiment, the first non-coated portion **171a** may be formed on the top of the first coated portion **171b**. The second non-coated portion **175a** may be formed on the bottom of the second coated portion **175b**.

[0081] When the first electrode **171** is an anode, the first active material may be an anode active material. When the second electrode **175** is a cathode, the second active material may be a cathode active material. The anode active material may include at least one of a material such as a lithium transition metal oxide and a nickel-cobalt-manganese lithium oxide. The cathode active material may include at least one of a carbon material, lithium, a lithium metal compound, silicon, a silicon compound, tin, a tin compound, and the like. The above-described embodiment is merely an example, and types of the anode active material and the cathode active material may not be limited.

[0082] In an embodiment, the electrode **170** may further include an insulating coating portion **165** formed at the boundary of the non-coated portion and the coated portion. The insulating coating portion **165** may include an insulating material. The insulating coating portion **165** may improve mechanical rigidity with respect to a portion which is bent from the non-coated portion to form a flag **170f**.

[0083] The separator **180** may include an inner separator **181** disposed between the first electrode **171** and the second electrode **175**, and an outer separator **182** disposed on the outer side. The separator **180** may include an insulating material. The separator **180** may block contact between the first electrode **171** and the second electrode **175** and electrically separate the first electrode **171** and the second electrode **175** from each other.

[0084] The electrode assembly **160** may be wound. In an embodiment, the electrode **170** and the separator **180** stacked on top of each other may be wound along a central axis C. The central axis C may be the height direction (e.g., the Z-axis direction). For example, the outer separator **182**, the first electrode **171**, the inner separator **181**, and the second electrode **175** stacked on top of each other may be wound along the central axis C.

[0085] The electrode **170** may include the flag **170f**. In an embodiment, when a portion of the non-coated portion is bent, the flag **170f** may be defined as a region from the bent portion to an end portion. In an embodiment, the non-coated portion may be bent at an angle in a range of 90 degrees or less relative to the XY plane. In an embodiment, the non-coated portion may be notched into a plurality of fragments. The plurality of fragments may be bent in the order from inner fragments to outer fragments.

[0086] The flag **170f** may include a first flag **171f** and a second flag **175f**. For example, the first flag **171f** may be formed by bending the first non-coated portion **171a** of the first electrode **171** in an inward direction toward the central axis C. The second flag **175f** may be formed by bending the second non-coated portion **175a** of the second electrode **175** in an inward direction toward the central axis C.

[0087] FIG. 5 is a cross-sectional view of the battery cell **100** according to an embodiment.

[0088] In FIG. 5, the opposing surface **111** is formed at the top of the battery cell, and the cap plate **120** closing the opening **114** may be disposed at the bottom thereof. For example, the beading portion **115** may be formed on the side surface portion adjacent to the cap plate **120** to be in contact with the second current collector plate **142**.

[0089] The beading portion **115** may restrict movement of the electrode assembly **160** or the second current collector plate **142** in the case **110**. The beading portion **115** may prevent the electrode assembly **160** or the second current collector plate **142** from being separated from the

case **110**. However, the present disclosure is not limited thereto, and the beading portion **115** may be omitted.

[0090] In an embodiment, an opposing surface **111** may include the vent portion **190** such that at least a portion may be opened at a predetermined pressure. The vent portion **190** may have a groove shape on the opposing surface **111** and have a smaller thickness than an adjacent region.

[0091] The vent portion **190** may be a notch formed in a downward direction from an upper surface of the opposing surface **111**, that is, in a direction toward the inside. A cross-sectional shape of the vent portion **190** may have a notch shape. The vent portion **190** may have a ring shape on the upper surface of the opposing surface **111**. When viewed from above with the opposing surface **111**, the vent portion **190** may have a ring shape. However, the shape of the vent portion **190** is not limited thereto, and may have a rectangular shape or a polygonal shape.

[0092] The vent portion **190** may have a shape of a figure which is continuously connected on the opposing surface **111**. For example, the vent portion **190** may have a form of a continuum in which straight lines or curved lines are connected to each other.

[0093] The vent portion **190** may be connected in a direction of 360 degrees with respect to the central axis C of the opposing surface **111**.

[0094] The vent portion **190** may be spaced apart from the electrode terminal **130** which passes through the opposing surface **111** and is exposed to the outside. The vent portion **190** may be formed between the circumference of the terminal and the circumference of the opposing surface **111**. The vent portion **190** may have a ring shape surrounding the terminal.

[0095] Referring to FIG. 5, the electrode assembly **160** may be wound along the central axis C.

[0096] The electrode assembly **160** may include a separator and an electrode. The electrode may include the flag **170f**. In an embodiment, the battery cell **100** may further include an electrolyte. The electrolyte may be, for example, a medium which transfers ions or current between the anode and cathode of the electrode assembly **160**.

[0097] The second current collector plate **142** may be electrically connected to the flag **170f** of the electrode **170**. For example, referring to FIGS. 3 and 4, the first current collector plate **141** may be electrically connected to the first flag **171f** of the first electrode **171**. In an embodiment, the first current collector plate **141** may be electrically connected to the electrode terminal **130**. The second current collector plate **142** may be electrically connected to the second flag **175f** of the second electrode **175**.

[0098] In an embodiment, the insulating gasket **135** may be disposed between the opposing surface **111** of the case **110** and the electrode terminal **130**. For example, the insulating gasket **135** may be disposed between the opposing surface **111** of the case **110** and the electrode terminal **130**.

[0099] The insulating gasket **135** may block contact between the electrode terminal **130** and the case **110**. The insulating gasket **135** may electrically separate the electrode terminal **130** and the case **110** from each other. That is, the electrode terminal **130** and the case **110** may have different polarities. For example, when the polarity of electrode terminal **130** is (+), the polarity of the case **110** may be (-).

[0100] FIG. 6 is a diagram for explaining a portion of the opposing surface **111** of the battery cell **100** according to an embodiment.

[0101] FIG. 6 is a partial enlarged view of FIG. 5 for explaining the vent portion **190**. The vent portion **190** is formed in a groove shape on the opposing surface **111** and may be formed by a laser.

[0102] The vent portion **190** may correspond to a region of the opposing surface **111** etched by a laser. With respect to a height along a direction from the opposing surface **111** toward the opening **114**, the opposing surface **111** may have a thickness of 0.6 mm. The vent portion **190** may have a height of 0.1 mm, which is lower than the opposing surface **111**.

[0103] In other words, the opposing surface **111** may have a thickness of 0.6 mm, and the vent portion **190** may have a height of 0.1 mm.

[0104] In an embodiment, the vent portion **190** may have a thickness equal to or less than $\frac{1}{6}$ of the

thickness of the opposing surface **111**. The thickness of the vent portion **190** is 20% or less of the thickness of the opposing surface **111**, and the vent portion **190** may be obtained by compressing the opposing surface **111** to approximately 80%. The vent portion **190** may be etched by a laser so that the thickness may be freely processed, compared to physical forging through a punch.

[0105] The shape of the vent portion **190** may be changed based on the internal pressure of the case **110**. The vent portion **190** may have a less height or a less thickness than an area adjacent to the vent portion **190**. When the internal pressure of the case **110** increases, the shape of the vent portion **190** may be changed before the area adjacent to the vent portion **190**.

[0106] At least a part of the vent portion **190** may be opened when the internal pressure of the case **110** increases. The vent portion **190** may be partially broken when the internal pressure of the case **110** increases. The vent portion **190** has a ring shape on the opposing surface **111**, and may be changed even when the internal pressure of the case **110** increases locally.

[0107] In an embodiment, the opposing surface **111** on which the vent portion **190** is formed may be formed integrally with the side surface portion.

[0108] The opposing surface **111** may extend from the side surface portion to the top. The opposing surface **111** may include the same material as the side surface portion. Accordingly, the opposing surface **111** may not be welded or physically coupled with the side surface portion.

[0109] The case **110** may be integrally formed except for the opening **114** formed on one surface. The case **110** may have a U-shape with one side opened.

[0110] The vent portion **190** may have a thickness smaller than the thickness of the side surface portion. When the internal pressure of the case **110** increases, it may be changed before the side surface portion.

[0111] FIG. 7 is a view for explaining a cross section of the vent portion **190** according to an embodiment.

[0112] FIG. 7 is an enlarged view of the vent portion **190** according to an embodiment. The vent portion **190** may be recessed from the upper surface of the opposing surface **111** toward the inside of the case **110**. The depth at which the vent portion **190** is recessed may be 80% or more of the thickness of the opposing surface **111**. That is, referring to FIG. 7, the thickness of the opposing surface **111** on which the vent portion **190** is formed may be 20% or less of the thickness of the opposing surface **111** on which no vent portion **190** is provided.

[0113] FIG. 7 briefly shows the cross section of the opposing surface **111** which was photographed by an Electron Back Scatter Diffraction (EBSD) method. According to the EBSD method, by installing an EBSD analyzer on a scanning electron microscope, when accelerated electrons are injected into a specimen, the electrons are detected to analyze the orientation of the material. In this manner, a crystal structure of the opposing surface **111** may be analyzed.

[0114] The vent portion **190** may be formed by heating using a laser. The vent portion **190** may include a re-solidification layer **25** formed by solidifying a region of an overlapping portion after heating. The re-solidification layer **25** may discolor after a part of the opposing surface **111** is heated and solidified. In an embodiment, the solidified region may be distinguished from other regions by color. The re-solidification layer **25** may be formed outside the vent portion **190**.

[0115] In an embodiment, the thickness of the re-solidification layer **25** in a direction from the inside to the outside of the opposing surface **111** may be 5 μm (micro-meter) or more, and more specifically, 3 μm or more.

[0116] More specifically, the re-solidification layer **25** may be formed by melting and then re-solidifying the opposing surface **111** when a pulse laser having a pulse width of 1 ns (nano-second) or more is used on the opposing surface **111**. The use of a pulse laser having a pulse width of less than 1 ns may not result in the formation of the re-solidification layer **25**.

[0117] The re-solidification layer **25** may contain vacancy defects. More specifically, the crystal structure of the re-solidification layer **25** may include vacancy defects. The vacancy defects are a form of point defects in the crystal structure, and may be formed depending on the external

environment such as heat and pressure. The vacancy defects may occur when atoms is absent from a lattice site, leaving holes or empty spaces in a crystal lattice.

[0118] As a result, some region of the battery cell **100** of the present disclosure may be heated and cooled to form the re-solidification layer **25**, and the re-solidification layer **25** may include vacancy defects.

[0119] In an embodiment, the opposing surface **111** may include vacancy defects. The number of vacancy defects may be measured in a unit volume of the material. The number of vacancy defects may be calculated by Equation 1 below when the number may increase exponentially with the increase in temperature.

[00001] $N_v = N \exp(-Q_v / kT)$ Equation1

[0120] Here, N_v is the number of vacancy defects, N is the number of potential defect sites, Q_v is the activation energy, T is the temperature (Kelvin scale), and k is the Boltzmann's constant.

[0121] In addition, the structure of the area adjacent to the vent portion **190** may have a form of a plurality of grains **200**. The plurality of grains **200** may be checked by observing the opposing surface **111** with a scanning electron microscope (SEM).

[0122] The structure of the area adjacent to the vent portion **190** may include an equiaxed microstructure. That is, the plurality of grains **200** have no orientations and may have similar lengths toward the three axes. The plurality of grains **200** may have isotropy since the opposing surface **111** was heated and the grains **200** grew next to each other toward the three axes.

[0123] At least a part of one of the plurality of grains **200** may be cut. The vent portion **190** is formed by etching the opposing surface **111** by a laser. That is, the vent portion **190** may be formed by etching the opposing surface **111** by the laser to reduce thermal damage to the opposing surface **111**.

[0124] The standard deviation of the size of the plurality of grains **200** may be 20 or less. That is, the plurality of grains **200** included in the overlapping portion may have a uniform size.

[0125] That is, the grains **200** were not subjected to external pressure after being heated and grown. The laser etching may be performed to cut the grains **200** irradiated by the laser to form the vent portion **190**, and the size of the grains **200** located in the opposing surface **111** may not be changed.

[0126] The ten-point average roughness (R_z) of the surface of the vent portion **190** may be higher than the ten-point average roughness (R_z) in the area adjacent to the vent portion **190**.

[0127] The surface roughness may be classified according to an analysis method for a roughness curve, and may include the maximum height roughness (R_{max} , R_y), the centerline average roughness (R_a), and the ten-point average roughness (R_z).

[0128] The maximum height roughness (R_{max} , R_y) is the distance expressed in μm between the two straight lines when parallel lines are drawn on the upper and lower parts of the center line of the surface roughness curve. The maximum height roughness (R_{max} , R_y) may refer to the difference in height, expressed in μm , between the highest point and the deepest valley in a reference length of the surface roughness curve. The maximum height roughness (R_{max} , R_y) may be defined as an average value of the maximum heights for each reference length in an evaluation length.

[0129] In the centerline average roughness (R_a), a line drawn to satisfy $S_1=S_2$ when the sum of the areas above the centerline of the surface roughness curve is S_1 , and the sum of the areas below the centerline is S_2 serves as the center line. The centerline average roughness (R_a) may represent the arithmetic mean of deviations with respect to the measurement length.

[0130] The ten-point average roughness (R_z) may refer to the distance between the two straight lines when the third peak at the highest point and the third valley at the lowest point are drawn parallel to the center line in the cross-sectional curve within the reference length (cut-off) of the collection part.

[0131] Alternatively, the ten-point average roughness (R_z) may be calculated through the average

height of the five highest peaks and the average depth of the five deepest valleys in a cross-sectional curve which represents the height of the surface. The ten-point average roughness (Rz) may be relative to the height measured in the longitudinal magnification direction in the roughness curve. The ten-point average roughness (Rz) may be the sum of the average value of the absolute values from the highest position to the fifth one and the average value of the absolute values from the lowest position to the fifth one in the roughness curve. The ten-point average roughness (Rz) may be expressed in micrometers (μm).

[0132] The ten-point average roughness (Rz) is a numerical value of the surface roughness. By a known method of measuring roughness, the roughness of the surface of the vent portion **190** and the surface of the area adjacent to the vent portion **190** may be measured.

[0133] More specifically, roughness may be measured via non-contact profilometry, contact profilometry, optical interferometry, or atomic microscopy. In FIG. 7, the re-solidification layer **25** may be formed on the surface of the vent portion **190**, and a relatively horizontal surface may be formed between inclined surfaces. The ten-point average roughness (Rz) may measure the roughness of a horizontal surface on the surface of the vent portion **190**.

[0134] The vent portion **190** is limited in width, so the roughness may be measured through optical interferometry using a microscope or the like. The microscope may measure a random position of the vent portion **190**, and the magnification may be set to $12\times$ to $200\times$. The microscope may measure a length of 2 to 3 mm at the vent portion **190**. The ten-point average roughness (Rz) of the surface of the vent portion **190** may be measured along the longitudinal direction of the vent portion **190** from an image obtained through the microscope. The ten-point average roughness (Rz) of the measured surface of the vent portion **190** may be greater than the surface of an area adjacent to the vent portion **190**. That is, the surface of the vent portion **190** may be rougher than the surface of the area adjacent to the vent portion **190**.

[0135] This is because the vent portion **190** is formed by the laser. When the vent portion **190** is formed by a pressing method other than laser, the pressed surface may be flat. However, in the present disclosure, the surface of the vent portion **190** may be roughened by forming the vent portion **190** by the laser. More specifically, the ten-point average roughness (Rz) of the surface of the vent portion **190** may exceed 20.

[0136] In the present disclosure, by forming the vent portion **190** by the laser, the vent portion **190** may be processed without any physical contact between the laser and the opposing surface **111**.

[0137] When the vent portion **190** is formed by the pressing method, a die may be inserted into the case **110**, and press may then be performed through a punch from the outside of the case **110**. The punch may come into physical contact with the outside of the case **110**, causing damage to the case **110** such as scratches and plating layers. In addition, physical deformation such as foreign substances or crushing may occur due to the press.

[0138] In the present disclosure, the vent portion **190** is formed by the laser, so that contamination by contact and damage to the case **110** may be prevented.

[0139] FIG. 8 is a diagram illustrating a method of manufacturing a battery cell according to an embodiment.

[0140] The electrode assembly **160** may include the first electrode **171**, a separator, and a second electrode. The case **110** of the battery cell **100** may include the opening **114** formed on one surface and the opposing surface **111** facing the opening **114**. The electrode assembly **160** may be accommodated in the case **110** through the opening **114** of the battery cell **100**.

[0141] The method of manufacturing the battery cell may include processing the opposing surface **111** to form the vent portion **190** at step S100. A process of manufacturing the case **110** may be performed before forming the vent portion **190**.

[0142] Step S100 of forming the vent portion **190** may include forming a start groove of the vent portion **190** by a laser (not shown) and etching the opposing surface **111** by the laser so that the vent portion **190** may form a ring shape in the start groove (not shown).

[0143] In the process of forming the start groove of the vent portion **190**, a portion of the vent portion **1900** may be etched by the laser to form the start groove. The start groove may correspond to a starting point for forming the vent portion **190** in a ring shape. The point at which the laser first starts etching on the opposing surface **111** may correspond to the start groove.

[0144] In the process of etching the opposing surface **111**, the opposing surface **111** may be continuously etched by the laser so that the vent portion **190** may form the ring shape in the start groove. Although the vent portion **190** forms the ring shape, the present disclosure is not limited thereto, and the vent portion **190** may have a polygonal shape having a continuous shape.

[0145] After the process of forming the vent portion **190** at step **S100**, the battery cell manufacturing method according to the present disclosure may include inserting the electrode assembly **160** into the case **110** at step **S300**. In addition, according to the method of manufacturing the battery cell according to the present disclosure, before the process of inserting the electrode assembly **160** at step **S300**, coupling the first current collector plate **141** to the first electrode **171** and coupling the second current collector plate **142** to the second electrode (not shown) may be performed.

[0146] In the process of coupling the current collector **140** to the electrode, the electrode assembly **160** and the current collector **140** may be coupled to each other. The first electrode **171** and the first current collector plate **141** may be coupled to each other, and the second electrode and the second current collector plate **142** may be coupled to each other, whereby the electrode and the current collector plate **140** may be electrically connected to each other.

[0147] Subsequently, at step **S300** of inserting the electrode assembly **160** into the case **110**, the electrode assembly **160** may be inserted into the case **110** through the opening **114** so that the first current collector plate **141** may face the opposing surface **111**. The first current collector plate **141** may be inserted into the case **110** before the second current collector plate **142**. Subsequently, the electrode terminal **130** penetrating the opposing surface **111** may be electrically connected to the first current collector plate **141**.

[0148] After step **S300** of inserting the electrode assembly **160** into the case **110**, the method of manufacturing the battery cell according to the present disclosure may further include coupling the cap plate **120** to the case **110** to close the opening **114** at step **S500**.

[0149] By coupling the case **110** and the cap plate **120** to each other, the inside of the case **110** may be disconnected from the outside.

[0150] According to an embodiment of the present disclosure, internal pressure may be controlled to improve stability.

[0151] According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, the internal pressure may be controlled by changing the shape of the vent portion.

[0152] According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, the vent portion is formed in a ring shape which surrounds an electrode terminal, and does not generate interference and form constraints during welding of the electrode terminal.

[0153] The present disclosure may be modified and implemented in various forms, and its scope is not limited to the above-described embodiments. The content described above is merely an example of applying the principles of the present disclosure, and other features may be further included without departing from the scope of embodiments according to the present disclosure.

Claims

1. A battery cell comprising: a case including an opening formed in one surface and an opposing surface facing the opening, and accommodating an electrode assembly through the opening; a cap plate coupled to the case to close the opening; and a vent portion having a shape of a groove on the opposing surface, wherein a ten-point average roughness of a surface of the vent portion is greater than a ten-point average roughness of an area adjacent to the vent portion.

2. The battery cell according to claim 1, wherein the vent portion has a ring shape on a side toward an outside of the case among both sides of the opposing surface.
3. The battery cell according to claim 1, further comprising a first current collector plate disposed between the opposing surface and the electrode assembly in the case and electrically connected to the electrode assembly.
4. The battery cell according to claim 3, further comprising an electrode terminal electrically connected to the first current collector plate and exposed to the outside through the opposing surface.
5. The battery cell according to claim 1, wherein the vent portion is changed in shape based on internal pressure of the case.
6. The battery cell according to claim 5, wherein at least a portion of the vent portion is opened when the internal pressure of the case increases.
7. The battery cell according to claim 1, wherein the groove has a thickness less than or equal to one-sixth of a thickness of the opposing surface.
8. The battery cell according to claim 1, wherein the area adjacent to the vent portion has a structure in a form of a plurality of grains, and a structure of the area adjacent to the vent portion includes an equiaxed microstructure, or the plurality of grains are isotropic.
9. The battery cell according to claim 8, wherein one of the plurality of grains is at least partially cut.
10. The battery cell according to claim 1, wherein the vent portion comprises a re-solidification layer formed by heating and solidifying a portion by using a laser.
11. The battery cell according to claim 10, wherein the ten-point average roughness of the surface of the vent portion exceeds 20.
12. A battery cell comprising: an electrode assembly including a first electrode (an anode), a separator, and a second electrode (a cathode); a case including an opening formed in one surface and an opposing surface facing the opening, and accommodating an electrode assembly through the opening to be electrically connected to the second electrode; a cap plate coupled to the case to close the opening; and a vent portion having a shape of a groove in the opposing surface.
13. The battery cell according to claim 12, further comprising an electrode terminal electrically connected to the first electrode and exposed to an outside through the opposing surface.
14. The battery cell according to claim 13, wherein the vent portion has a ring shape surrounding the electrode terminal on a side facing the outside of the case among both sides of the opposing surface.
15. The battery cell according to claim 12, further comprising: a first current collector plate electrically connected to the first electrode between the opposing surface and the first electrode in the case; and a second current collector plate electrically connected to the second electrode between the cap plate and the second electrode in the case.
16. A method of manufacturing a battery cell accommodating an electrode assembly including a first electrode, a separator, and a second electrode in a case including an opening formed in one surface of the battery cell and an opposing surface facing the opening, the method comprising: forming a vent portion by processing the opposing surface.
17. The method according to claim 16, wherein the forming the vent portion comprises: forming a start groove of the vent portion by a laser; and etching the opposing surface through the laser so that the vent portion forms a ring shape in the start groove.
18. The method according to claim 16, further comprising, after the forming of the vent portion: coupling a first current collector plate with the first electrode and a second current collector plate to the second electrode; and inserting the electrode assembly into the case through the opening so that the first current collector plate faces the opposing surface.
19. The method according to claim 18, further comprising coupling a cap plate to the case to close the opening after the inserting of the electrode assembly into the case.

20. A battery cell comprising: a case including an opening formed in one surface and an opposing surface facing the opening, and accommodating the electrode assembly through the opening; a cap plate coupled to the case to close the opening; and a vent portion having a shape of a groove on the opposing surface, wherein a surface of the vent portion is rougher than a surface of an area adjacent to the vent portion.
